

```
[bash]$ echo $RANDOM
12746
```

```
[bash]$ echo $RANDOM
1346
```

—Narendra Kangralkar,  
narendrakangralkar@gmail.com



## Create a simple chat server using the nc command

GNU/Linux provides the `nc` (netcat) command which can be used to implement a simple chat server. This command is available by default on most GNU/Linux distributions. Let us now see how to create the client and server.

Create a server listening at port number 4500:

```
[bash]$ nc -l 4500 #server
```

Connect to the server at port number 4500 from the client machine:

```
[bash]$ nc 127.0.0.1 4500 #client
```

Now the connection is established between client and server. From here onwards, whatever message you type on the client machine will get delivered to the server machine and vice versa. Shown below is the sample output of the client-server communication:

```
[bash]$ nc -l 4500 #server
```

```
First message from client
Second message from client
Reply from server to client
```

```
[bash]$ nc 127.0.0.1 4500 #client
```

```
First message from client
Second message from client
Reply from server to client
```

—Narendra Kangralkar,  
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## Set the title for a Linux (\*nix) terminal

The most user friendly way to do this is by using the menu `Terminal -> "Set Title..."`.

There are other ways too, using which you can issue the following command in the terminal:

```
echo -en "\033]0;SOME TITLE HERE\007"
```

Yet another way to set the title is as follows:

Edit `.bashrc` and add the following function:

```
function title {
    echo -en "\033]2;$1\007"
}
```

Also comment out `PS1`.

Now open a new terminal and type the following command:

```
title "MyTitle"
```

...where "MyTitle" is your title of choice.

—Manu S Ajith,  
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## Find any string in any project, recursively

If you want to search for a string in any file inside the folder, you can use the following command.

First go to the folder using the `cd` command, and then type:

```
#grep -r "mystring" <path_of_the_folder>
#grep -r -i "MyString" //for case in-sensitive search
```

—Aju John,  
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## Knowing more about your OS

There are many graphical ways and tools that can help you to know your Linux distribution and other related information. But, here are a few tricks to get this information by using commands on your terminal. The commands you could use are:

- 1) `cat /etc/issue` or `cat/etc/issue.net`
- 2) `cat /etc/*-release`
- 3) `lsb_release -a`

There are a few more methods, depending on your GNU/Linux distro.

—Rahul Mahale,  
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## Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at [www.opensourceforu.com](http://www.opensourceforu.com). The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.